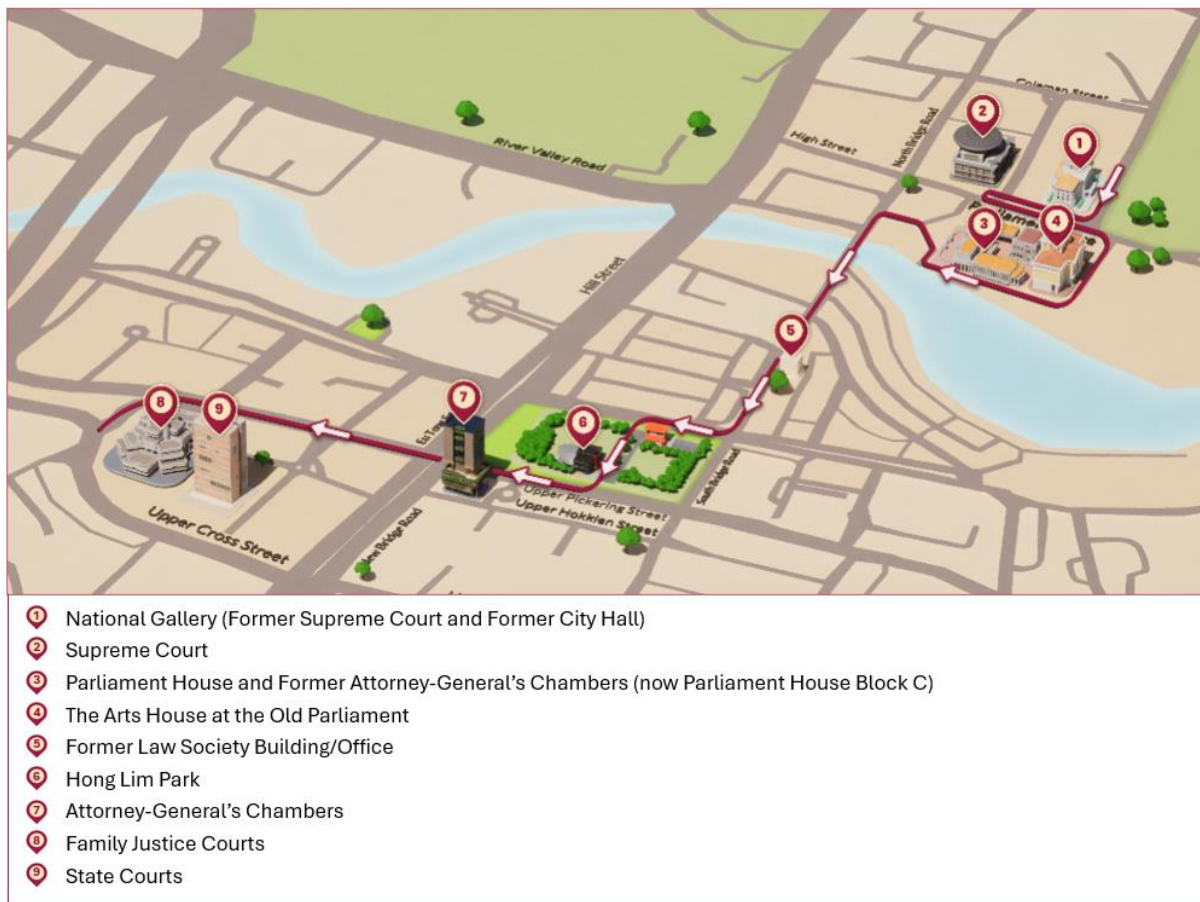


MEDIA FACTSHEET

DETAILS OF GUIDED WALKING TOUR OF HERITAGE TRAIL

The heritage trail, titled “In Place and Progress: Tracing the Rule of Law through Singapore’s Legal Landmarks” showcases 20 locations with significance to the Rule of Law in Singapore. All 20 locations can be explored through an interactive virtual guide at www.sglaw200explore.sg. Members of the public are also encouraged to join the free guided walking tours, which cover 9 of the 20 locations. They will be led by a docent who will bring the stories behind these landmarks to life. Highlights of the guided walking tours are set out below.



Route of Guided Walking Tour

Highlights of Key Stops Along the Guided Walking Tour

(Please visit the website link above for more details on the full list of stops.)

- **National Gallery Singapore** (Former Supreme Court Building and Former City Hall)



The former Supreme Court building and former City Hall, 1962.¹

The former Supreme Court building housed Singapore's highest court, the Supreme Court, for over 60 years, from 1939 until 2005, witnessing numerous landmark cases that shaped Singapore's legal landscape. During this time, other significant reforms were also made. This included the abolishment of jury trials in 1969, out of concerns that jurors might be swayed by personal prejudice or emotion, rather than evidence and law. Decisions were instead entrusted solely to trained judges, reinforcing the principle that justice should be administered in a consistent and impartial manner, a key tenet of the Rule of Law.

A lesser known fact about the National Gallery is that a time capsule containing Singapore newspapers from 1937 and currency from the Straits Settlements were placed under the foundation stone of the former Supreme Court building (now part of the National Gallery), to be retrieved in the year 3000. This perhaps suggested that the British had expected that the Supreme Court and the principles it stood for would withstand the test of time when it was first built.

¹ Source: National Archives (Singapore) (<https://www.nas.gov.sg/archivesonline/photographs/record-details/87e63f06-1162-11e3-83d5-0050568939ad>)

- ***The Arts House at the Old Parliament***



*The Arts House as the Supreme Court, 1900s*²

Probably Singapore's oldest surviving government building, The Arts House was originally constructed as a private residence, but it was never used as one. Instead, it became Singapore's first courthouse following the promulgation of the Second Charter of Justice in 1826, hosting the first session of the Court of Judicature of Prince of Wales' Island (Penang), Singapore and Malacca on 22 May 1828.

Over the years, it has been home to the Supreme Court of the Straits Settlements, Singapore's Parliament, and various public offices. Within these walls, all three branches of government have sat at different points in time – the Legislature, which makes the law; the Executive, which administers the law; and the Judiciary, which interprets the law through the courts.

² Source: The National Archives (Singapore)
(<https://www.nas.gov.sg/archivesonline/photographs/record-details/3c09de83-1162-11e3-83d5-0050568939ad>)

- **Hong Lim Park**



*Open-air theatre at Hong Lim Park, 1965*³

This part of South Bridge Road was once a hub for law enforcement. The Central Police Station and Police Courts used to be here, and locals used to call this area 'Po-lay Po' or simply 'Po-lay', meaning 'police area' in dialect. These buildings were later demolished when the subordinate courts moved to the new Subordinate Courts building at Havelock Road in 1975.

The only colonial building to survive at Hong Lim Park is the former North Canal Road Post Office. The post office was subsequently closed and converted into the Kreta Ayer Neighbourhood Police Post, which opened in 1990.

³ Source: Ministry of Information and the Arts Collection, courtesy of National Archives of Singapore (<https://www.nas.gov.sg/archivesonline/photographs/record-details/c319f5b2-1161-11e3-83d5-0050568939ad>)